WHS ALERT #129

'Edge board plywood falling 4.37M to GF during stripping'

What Happened:	**Incident Summary:** At approximately 9:30 am on Monday, 14 September 2026 at Liverpool Hospital, a worker from the formwork stripping crew was removing edge boards from the slab edge at Level 1, Pour H. During the activity, the worker had temporarily leaned a stripped edge board plywood against the scaffold edge protection while removing the next edge board from the slab. While removing the next section of the edge board from the slab, a plywood section impacted the edge board positioned against the scaffold edge protection. This impact caused the plywood to pass through a 55mm gap between the mesh and deck, falling approximately 4.37m to Ground Floor, Pour G. Although an exclusion zone had been established below, it did not extend the full length of the work area. As a result, the plywood landed just outside of the exclusion zone, within an area that remained restricted due to ongoing works. The dimensions of the fallen plywood sections were ~450mm × 1,720mm & 500mm × 1,410mm. No personnel were working in the immediate vicinity at the time of the incident. The Ground Floor area had been restricted due to perimeter scaffold erection works, and the crane crew was also landing shutters in the area. All workers were positioned well clear of the incident location. All works ceased, notification to Lendlease Management and BKH Management. This further was reported to SafeWork NSW who released the scene immediately.  **Figure A** – Edge board which has fallen from Level 1- Pour H (Approx. 4.37m) down to GF Pour G.

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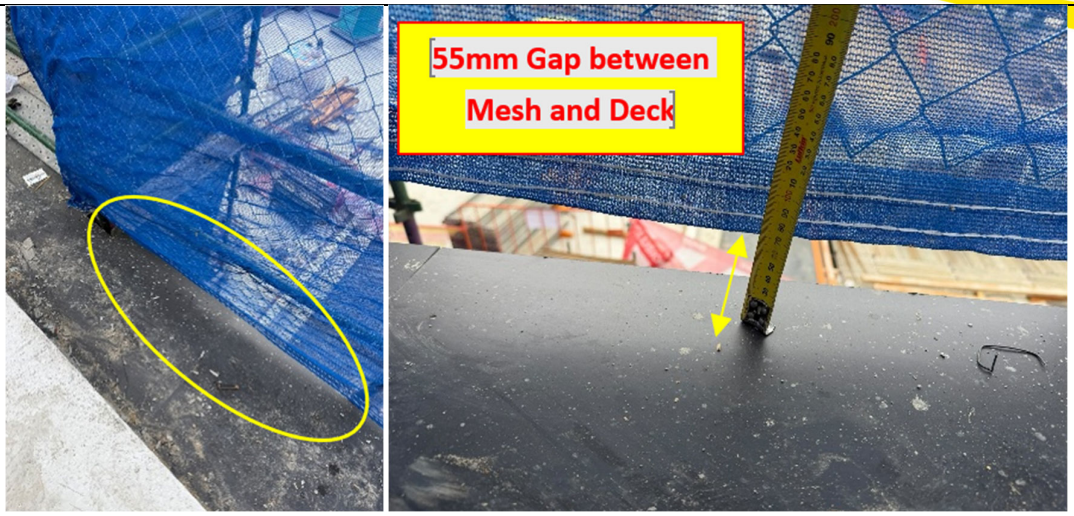
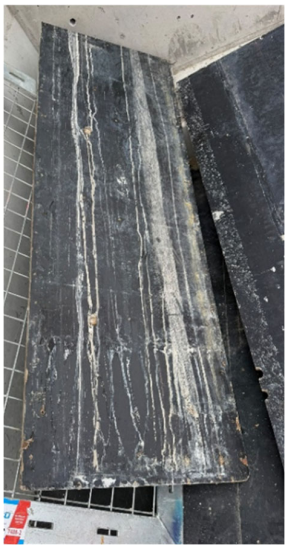


Figure B – Area from where the edge board fell through the gap (Approx. 55mm) between the mesh and the deck and landed on GF, Pour G.



Plywood 1 - 450mm × 1,720mm



Plywood 2 - 500mm × 1,410mm

Figure C- Edge board – Plywood section sizes which had fallen

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Figure D- Area excluded before the incident – Area where edge board landed

Key Learnings:

- ✓ Make sure exclusion zones are established in entirety and at all possible entry points of all stripping works, and wherever there is a potential to have a dropped object.
- ✓ Ensure all gaps are adequately covered or closed before commencing work.
- ✓ Review slab configurations where kickboards have not been installed.
- ✓ Maintain good housekeeping practices. Stripped materials must be stored well clear of edges to minimise the risk of dropped objects.

What we need to do:

- Conduct a Toolbox Talk on this Safety Alert with all site team.
- Ensure all workers adequately plan their tasks before commencing work.
- Establish full complete exclusion zones for all stripping works at any possible entry points to the stripping and potential area material can fall into.
- Identify gaps prior to stripping and ensure covered prior to commencment of works.
- Verify that all work areas are clear of loose materials prior to starting any task to eliminate the risk of falling objects.

For further information, Contact:

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